

Virtual Agent Design and Configuration

Overview

The **Virtual Agent Design** phase focuses on implementing a conversational interface to support proactive SLA governance within the ServiceNow platform. Instead of relying only on email notifications and manual follow-ups, the Virtual Agent provides users with real-time guidance whenever an Incident approaches or exceeds its Service Level Agreement (SLA).

To enable this functionality, the **ITSM Virtual Agent** plugin is installed and configured. A dedicated Virtual Agent topic named "**SLA Breach Awareness & Justification**" is later created to educate users about SLA risk, capture acknowledgement, and guide them toward completing the required governance activities on the Incident record.

The Virtual Agent complements the standard Incident Management process by improving user awareness and accountability without replacing existing Incident form updates.

Objectives

The objectives of this phase are to:

- Enable Virtual Agent capabilities within ServiceNow.
 - Install the ITSM Virtual Agent plugin.
 - Provide conversational SLA awareness.
 - Guide users through corrective actions.
 - Capture SLA acknowledgement.
 - Improve user engagement and governance compliance.
 - Reduce manual communication through automated conversations.
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Plugin Installation

Before designing the Virtual Agent conversation, the **ITSM Virtual Agent** plugin must be installed.

This plugin provides the conversational framework required for creating Virtual Agent topics and user interactions.

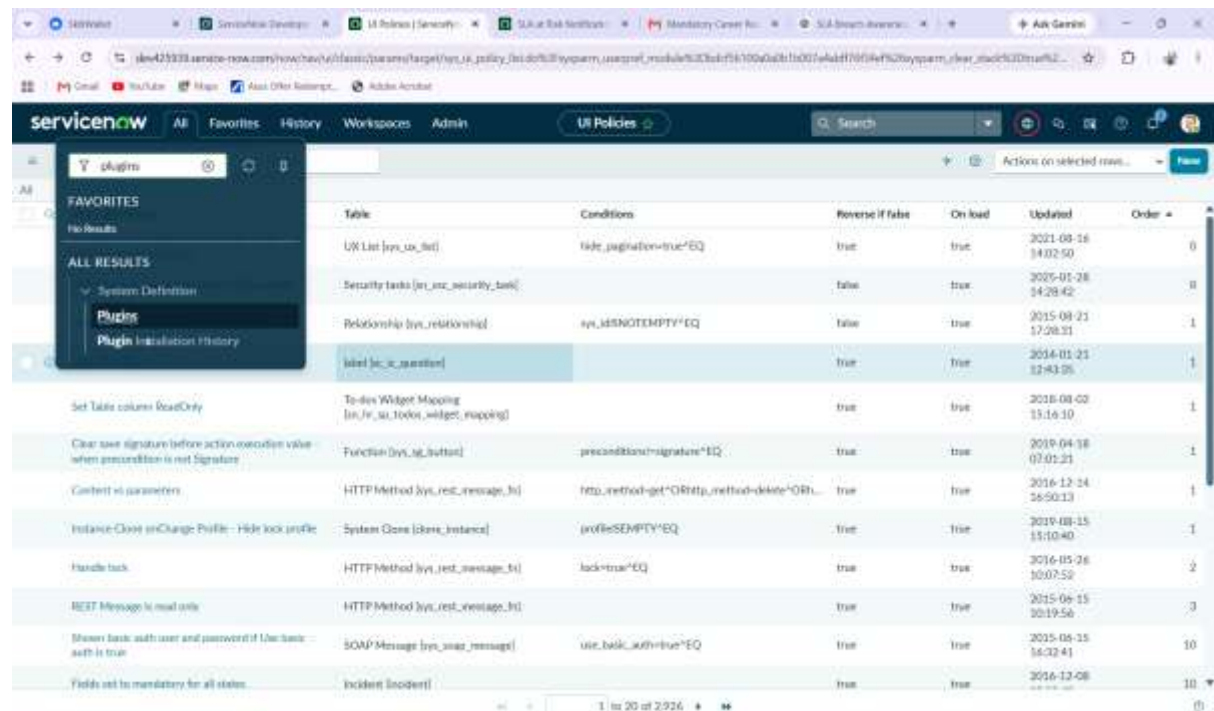
Navigation

Navigate to:

System Definition → Plugins

Search for:

ITSM Virtual Agent



Name	Conditions	Reverse if false	On load	Updated	Order
UX List [sys_ui_list]	hide_pagination=true^EQ	true	true	2021-08-16 14:02:50	0
Security tasks [sys_sec_security_task]		false	true	2025-01-28 14:28:42	0
Relationship [sys_relationship]	sys_idNOTEMPTY^EQ	false	true	2015-09-21 17:28:31	1
Isid [is_id_question]		true	true	2016-01-21 12:43:05	1
Set Table column ReadOnly	To-Do Widget Mapping [in_fr_so_todo_widget_mapping]	true	true	2016-08-02 13:16:10	1
Clear row signature before action execution value when precondition is not Signature	Function [sys_ui_button]	true	true	2019-04-18 07:01:21	1
Context is parameters	HTTP Method [sys_rest_message_in]	true	true	2016-12-24 16:50:13	1
Instance Close onChange Profile - Hide lock profile	System Close [close_instance]	true	true	2019-08-15 15:10:40	1
Handle lock	HTTP Method [sys_rest_message_in]	true	true	2016-05-26 10:07:52	2
REST Message is read only	HTTP Method [sys_rest_message_in]	true	true	2015-06-15 20:19:56	3
Shows back auth user and password if Use back auth is true	SOAP Message [sys_soap_message]	true	true	2015-06-15 14:32:41	10
Fields set to mandatory for all states	Incident [incident]	true	true	2016-12-08	10

Step 1: Search for the Plugin

1. Open **System Definition → Plugins**.
2. In the search box, type:

ITSM Virtual Agent

3. Locate the **ITSM Virtual Agent Conversations** plugin.

Step 2: Install the Plugin

Open the plugin record.

Verify the plugin information.

Click:

Install

Wait until the installation process completes successfully.

After installation, the Virtual Agent features become available within the ServiceNow instance.

Plugin Configuration Summary

Field	Value
Plugin Name	ITSM Virtual Agent Conversations
Navigation	System Definition → Plugins
Action	Install
Status	Active

Purpose of Installing the Plugin

The ITSM Virtual Agent plugin enables:

- Conversational chatbot functionality.
 - Creation of Virtual Agent topics.
 - Decision-based conversation flows.
 - Guided user interactions.
 - Integration with Incident Management.
 - Support for SLA governance workflows.
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Role in SLA Governance

Once installed, the Virtual Agent is used to support SLA governance by:

- Informing users when an Incident reaches the SLA risk threshold.
- Explaining the impact of SLA breaches.
- Guiding users through corrective actions.
- Capturing SLA acknowledgement.

- Directing users to update SLA Breach Reason and SLA Breach Justification on the Incident form.
- Reinforcing organizational SLA compliance policies.

The Virtual Agent acts as an intelligent assistant, improving communication and ensuring users understand the actions required to maintain SLA compliance.

Validation

After installation, verify the following:

- The **ITSM Virtual Agent Conversations** plugin is successfully installed.
 - The plugin status is **Active**.
 - Virtual Agent modules appear in the Application Navigator.
 - The platform is ready for creating Virtual Agent topics and conversation flows.
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Expected Outcome

After completing this step:

- The ITSM Virtual Agent capability is enabled.
 - The ServiceNow instance is prepared for conversational interactions.
 - Administrators can begin designing Virtual Agent topics.
 - The foundation is established for SLA Breach Awareness conversations.
 - Users will be able to interact with the Virtual Agent through the Service Portal.
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Benefits

- Improves user experience through conversational guidance.
- Reduces dependency on manual follow-up.
- Supports proactive SLA governance.
- Encourages timely corrective action.
- Increases user engagement and accountability.
- Integrates seamlessly with Incident Management.
- Uses native ServiceNow functionality without custom scripting.

Conclusion

Installing the **ITSM Virtual Agent Conversations** plugin is the first step in enabling conversational SLA governance within the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System**. The plugin provides the infrastructure required to create intelligent chatbot interactions that notify users of SLA risks, explain required actions, and improve compliance through guided conversations. This configuration enhances the overall user experience while supporting proactive, audit-ready SLA governance using native ServiceNow capabilities.